capito

IDEM · CATALAN CORPUS · VERSION 1.4

383 Catalan sentences, rewritten in easy-to-read form

A sentence-aligned corpus of Barcelona public-information texts and their human-made Lectura Fàcil versions at A2 level. Every simplification is annotated with the DINCAT easy-to-read criteria that produced it.

idem_corpus_ca_v1.4.json · 5 November 2026 · simplified by DINCAT

14 source documents from Barcelona institutions	**105** texts, CAT_001 to CAT_105	**383** original sentences (alignments)
1,379 lines of easy-to-read text	**9,612** words in the originals	**25** DINCAT criteria codes in use

WHAT IT IS

Shorter lines, more explanation

Each original sentence is paired with its easy-to-read version, on average **3.6 lines** and up to 17. The lines are short, **8.7 words** against **25.1** for an original sentence. But the texts grow to **124%** of the original length, because the translators add explanations and glosses for hard words.

Annotated per simplification

Every simplified entry names the criteria from the DINCAT catalogue that were applied to it, **1.5 codes** on average. 279 entries also mark which parts of the original were hard, and 69 sentences carry review notes where meaning shifted or content was lost.

SOURCES

All texts come from Barcelona institutions: the city council (ajuntament.barcelona.cat, barcelona.cat and its electronic office), the city's ombudsman (sindicaturabarcelona.cat) and the participation platform decidim.barcelona. They cover social services and taxation, tourism policy, civic participation, social justice, data protection and accessibility. Seven documents are informative texts; the rest are policy and administrative documents and analyses. All are copyright cleared.

The Catalan, Spanish and Italian iDEM corpora are not parallel. Each language has its own catalogue and conventions, so criterion codes must never be compared across languages.

STRUCTURE

Three parts, four levels deep

The file is one JSON object. Metadata and the criteria list sit beside the data. Inside each simplified entry, the easy-to-read lines are separated by line breaks.

corpus — object

version, date, source file, change log, notes, counts

criteria — 25 entries

code, description, description_en, group, in_official_catalogue, times_used

documents — 14 entries

the data, see below

document — 14 · e.g. CAT_002_006 = texts CAT_002 to CAT_006

document_id · metadata: source_url, creation_date, characters_without_spaces, corpus_category, text_type, topic, complexity_level, simplification_method, institution, tested_by_user_group, copyright_cleared

text — 105 · e.g. CAT_001

text_id · translator_id

alignment — 383 · e.g. CAT_001-1 = 1st sentence of CAT_001

alignment_id · **original** · source_row · quality_flags (optional)

simplified — 408 · usually 1 per alignment

position · **text** (lines separated by \n) · criteria_codes · complex_parts · source_row · quality_flags (optional)

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Alignment CAT_001-1

ORIGINAL

Àpats a domicili
El servei d'àpats a domicili dona suport alimentari a aquelles persones que, per la seva situació personal, no poden preparar-se els àpats, necessiten ajuda per fer-ho o no tenen un habitatge en condicions per cuinar aliments.

SIMPLIFIED · ONE ENTRY · 7 LINES

1 Menjars a domicili
2 Hi ha un servei d'ajuda que porta el menjar a casa.
3 Aquest servei és per a persones que tenen problemes per cuinar.
4 Aquests problemes poden ser:
5 - per la seva situació personal no poden preparar el menjar.
6 - Necessiten ajuda per cuinar.
7 - La cuina de casa seva està en mal estat.

criteria for the whole entry: 18 14 10 26

The whole easy-to-read version sits in one entry; split its text on line breaks to get the lines. The codes describe the entry as a whole: 18 = familiar words, 14 = simple syntax, 10 = lists for enumerations, 26 = pronouns with a clear referent.

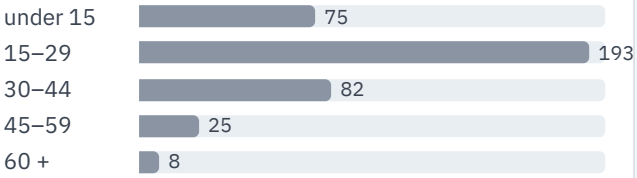
SENTENCES

Long sentences become short lines

Original sentences have mostly 15 to 29 words. The simplifications break them into lines of mostly 5 to 12 words.

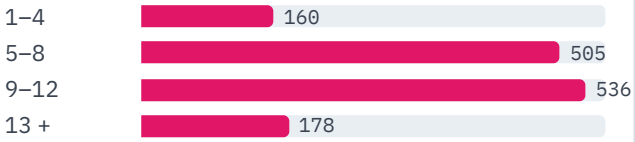
Words per original sentence

Number of alignments, n = 383



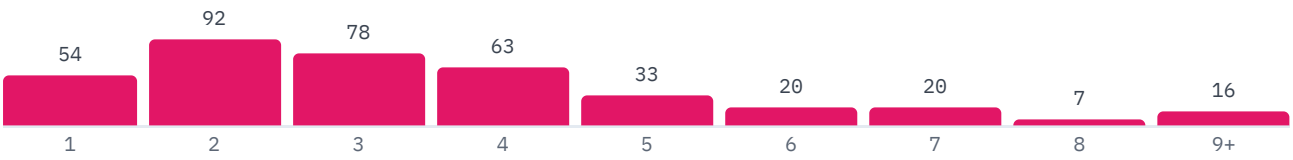
Words per simplified line

Number of lines, n = 1,379



How many lines does one original sentence become?

Number of alignments by count of simplified lines



simplified lines per original sentence

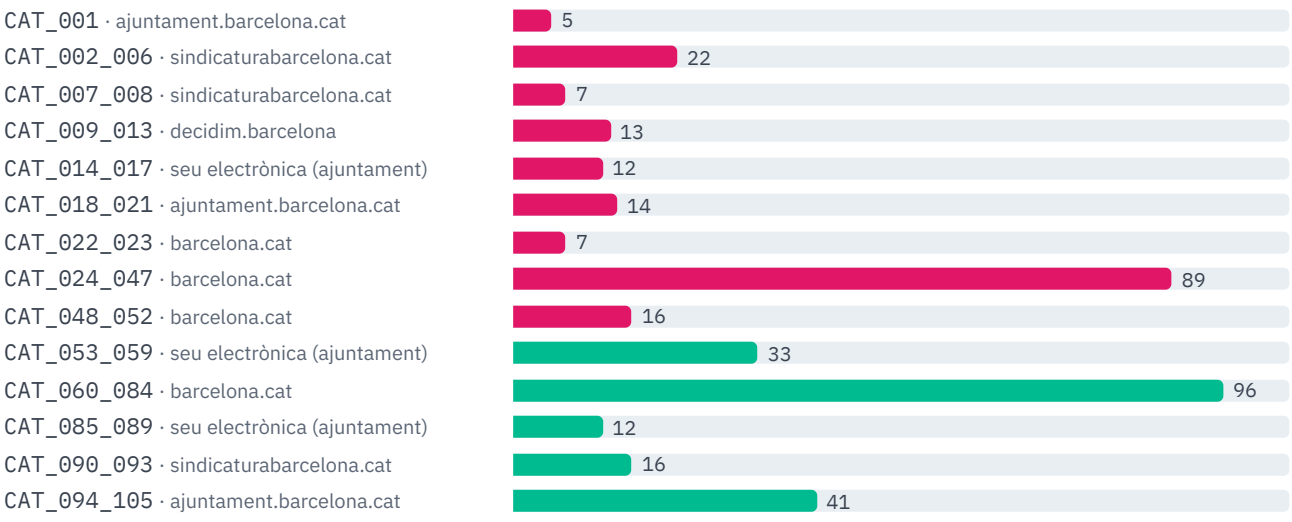
Most sentences become 2 to 4 lines. 54 stay a single line, mostly headings and short items; 16 are split into nine or more.

DOCUMENTS

Two documents make up half of the corpus

Alignments per document, by translator

translator_4 · 52 texts · 185 alignments translator_5 · 53 texts · 198 alignments



CAT_060_084 (social services and taxation) and CAT_024_047 (news on tourism policy) hold 185 of 383 alignments. translator_4 simplified the first half of the corpus, translator_5 the second.

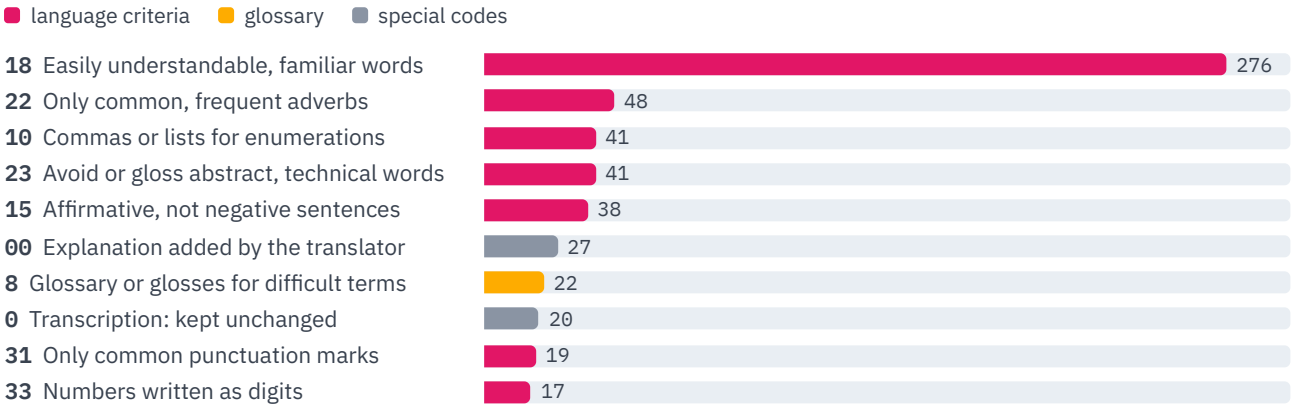
CRITERIA

Familiar words first

The DINCAT catalogue has codes 1–38 for language, 39–60 for format and 61+ for accessibility, plus **0** (sentence kept unchanged) and **00** (explanation added). This corpus uses 23 language codes plus 0 and 00; the JSON lists only those 25. Across the corpus, 620 codes are applied.

The ten most used criteria

Number of simplified entries carrying the code



Code 18 sits on 68% of all simplified entries: choosing familiar words is part of almost every simplification. In criteria analyses, consider looking at it separately so it does not dominate.

Why the Catalan texts get longer

Length of the simplification as a share of the original, mean per alignment



When translators add a gloss, the simplification grows to almost three times the original length. Without one, it still grows a little, because short sentences replace subordinate clauses.

QUALITY

Review notes

69 of 383 alignments carry review flags in `quality_flags`, mostly about narrowed or shifted meaning and lost content. Flags starting with `[v1.3]` or `[v1.4]` record corrections made in the JSON and name the Excel cells to fix.

Version 1.4

28 clear orthography errors corrected in 27 simplified entries: 27 spaces after an apostrophe (*l' Ajuntament* becomes *l'Ajuntament*) and *jutgats* for *jutjats*. Original texts are unchanged.

USING IT

Reading the corpus correctly

The Catalan file is organised differently from the Spanish one: the easy-to-read lines sit together inside one entry, not in separate entries.

THINGS TO KNOW WHEN READING IT

POINT	WHAT TO DO
One entry holds several lines	Split `text` on `\n` to get the lines.
22 alignments have 2 or 3 entries	Join all entries in `position` order; the extra ones usually add a gloss.
Codes describe the whole entry	Analyse criteria per entry, not per line. Codes are strings, including `"0"` and `"00"`.
Two apostrophe styles (’ and ')	Normalise them before tokenising or comparing strings.
Website leftovers in 3 originals	`Tramit_Page.Description…` in CAT_054-2, CAT_054-4, CAT_055-2. Remove before text analysis.

READING IT IN PYTHON

```python
import json

corpus = json.load(open("idem_corpus_ca_v1.4.json", encoding="utf-8"))

for doc in corpus["documents"]:
    for text in doc["texts"]:
        for al in text["alignments"]:
            entries = sorted(al["simplified"], key=lambda s: s["position"])
            lines = [l for s in entries for l in s["text"].split("\n") if l.strip()]
            print(al["alignment_id"], al["original"], lines)
```

The full helper script, read_idem_corpus_ca.py, and the README sit next to the JSON file.

VERSIONS

VERSION	DATE	CHANGES
1.4	2026-11-05	28 clear orthography errors corrected in 27 simplified entries. Original texts and proper names unchanged. Each correction carries a `[v1.4]` flag.
1.3	2026-09-25	text_id corrections, criteria entries completed, counts recomputed.

FILES

FILE	CONTENT
idem_corpus_ca_v1.4.json	The corpus
README_corpus_ca.md	Structure, field reference, statistics and known issues
read_idem_corpus_ca.py	Helper functions to load, walk and flatten the corpus into tables
analyse_idem_corpus_ca.py	Short exploratory analysis of the corpus
analysis_results_ca.txt	The output of the analysis